The Three Cs of Ethics

BUEN 594 · Ethics panel
Tuesday, November 10 · 12:40 p.m.
Fox Commons, Business and Entrepreneurship Center

As a COMPASS
ethics guide you

Your ethics set your direction in work and life: which job you take, whom you serve, what you will not do. Repeated choices shape the person you become.

As a CONUNDRUM
ethics implicate you

Work often offers no clearly right answer, and someone gets let down, sometimes you. Not choosing is itself a choice, with consequences. A hard look can sometimes still turn up a win-win solution.

As a CRUCIBLE
ethics test you

Choosing under pressure carries a toll and a thrill. It weighs on your body, emotions, conscience, and relationships, and it can show you who you are.

Name your ethics

PEOPLE FIRST



The Loyal Soldier
Orders are orders.

Hiroo Onoda kept fighting in the Philippines until 1974, when his old commander came to relieve him of his orders.

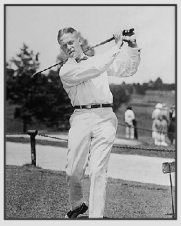


The Fixer
Whatever it takes for my boss.

Michael Cohen, Trump's lawyer for years, said he would "take a bullet" for him. Loyalty to the boss is what many jobs reward: it built his career. In 2018 he was sentenced to three years in prison.

PROCESS FIRST

RESULTS FIRST



The Referee
A foul is a foul, even on me.

Bobby Jones called a penalty on himself at the 1925 U.S. Open that no official had seen. He lost in a playoff.



The Advocate
Some rules deserve to be broken.

Rosa Parks refused to give up her bus seat in Montgomery in 1955 and was arrested under the city's bus-segregation law.

PRINCIPLES FIRST

Three ethics cases



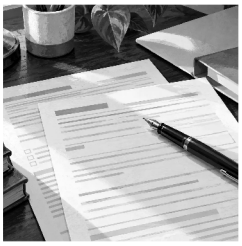
The Coaching Intern

You are interning with a youth basketball program. All season you have told your players that everyone gets fair playing time. Now, in close games, the head coach plays only the starters, and the kids you coached sit on the bench. What do you do?



Full Disclosure

A donor believes a shelter serves U.S. citizens. Intern Jenny knows it serves Central American immigrants who are not U.S. citizens. Her fundraising director lets the misunderstanding stand and accepts a large check.



Scholarship Application

With a scholarship deadline tomorrow, a supervisor tells intern Chris to copy a withdrawn applicant's work into another applicant's submission. Chris says he is uncomfortable. The supervisor says that is how things are done locally and wants it finished.

Ethics at work: from how you behave each day to which kind of work you choose

The smile

In *The Managed Heart* (1983), Arlie Hochschild named the smile a job demands "emotional labor," studying flight attendants paid to stay courteous with rude passengers. Some say that warmth is work and should be paid like work. Others say it is simply part of serving people well.

The iced coffee

In September a recruiter's TikTok told job seekers to finish their iced coffee before the interview, and Gen Z objected loudly. For some, the cup signals a casual attitude. For others, judging a drink instead of a candidate is snobbery about class and taste.

The effort

On *The Pitt*, unpaid medical student Joy Kwon walks out at the end of her twelve-hour shift while the emergency room is still in crisis, saying the staff need better boundaries. To some she is guarding against burnout. To others she is leaving her team when it needs her most.

Who you work for

Oshkosh Corporation, twenty miles south of campus, builds Pierce fire trucks, JLG lifts, mail trucks, and, through Oshkosh Defense, military vehicles. For some, building what soldiers drive is a calling and a good career. Others will not take that work. The choice is clearest before you sign.

Next week, our guests include Lawrence alumni and Appleton's mayor, Jake Woodford. Each of them was new at work once. They'll tell stories from those years: moments with little authority and something at stake.

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